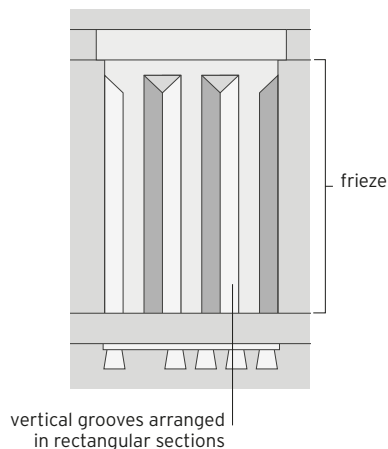


TRANSEPT The parts of a cruciform church that are at right angles to the principal axis, as in the arms of a cross. *See also* church, cruciform.

TRIGLYPH ▼ A design element found on friezes of the Doric order in ancient Greek architecture; it consists of a panel scored with three vertical grooves. *See also* Doric, order.



TROMPE L'OEIL A painting that aims to deceive the viewer into thinking that it is a three-dimensional object.

TRUSS *See* panel, below.

TUMULUS A large mound of earth raised over a burial site. Tumuli are also known as barrows.

TUNNEL VAULT An alternative name for a barrel vault. *See also* barrel vault, vault.

TUSCAN An order of Classical architecture simpler than all others, with an unadorned shaft that sits on an unadorned base and has an unadorned capital. *See also* order.

TYMPANUM In Classical architecture, the triangular or semicircular part of the wall

over an entrance or window. It often contains sculpture or other decoration.

U

UNDERCROFT A cellar or storage room.

V

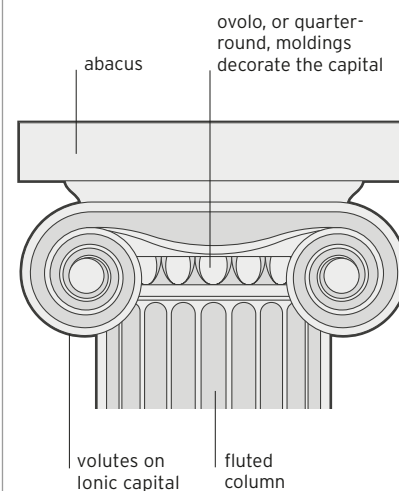
VAULT *See* panel, right.

VERNACULAR ARCHITECTURE
The domestic architecture of a region.

VESTIBULE A small foyer leading into a larger space.

VIADUCT A long bridge composed of many small spans that crosses a valley floor, an area of wetland, or a stretch of water.

VIMANA The pyramidlike tower of a Hindu temple in South India; its equivalent in North India is called a shikhara.



VOLUTE ▲ The scroll-like ornament that decorates the capitals of columns in the Ionic order. *See also* Ionic, order.

VOUSSOIR The wedge-shaped stone used in forming the curve of an arch. *See also* arch.

VYSE A spiral staircase or a staircase that winds around a central column.

W

WAINSCOT The paneled wooden lining of an interior wall. It can also refer specifically to the lower portion of an interior wall if this is finished differently from the rest.

WAT A Buddhist sacred precinct.

TRUSS

A truss is a flat structural framework of beams, joists, and posts. The simplest truss is a single triangle, but trusses more commonly consist of a combination of triangles. It is a form that offers great rigidity because a triangle cannot be distorted by stress. Individual trusses are typically set in parallel, resting on supporting walls and tied together by purlins and a ridge beam. The two simplest trusses are the king and queen trusses. A queen truss can support a roof spanning a greater distance than a king truss.

